

Section A: Television

This section consists of an in-depth study of television as a media form and focuses on two media products – one historical and one contemporary – chosen to illustrate continuities and changes in mainstream television drama over time. These two media products should be used as a case study, applying the theoretical framework and media contexts to detailed textual study, enabling learners to:

- demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the theoretical framework in relation to the products
- analyse an unknown extract from one of the two media products, using the theoretical framework of media, including in relation to its contexts, making judgements and drawing conclusions, as required
- demonstrate knowledge and understanding of media contexts in relation to the products.

In this section, learners are required to study the following media products set by OCR:

Media Form	Television	Television
Set Media Product	<i>Vigil</i> Series 1, Episode 1, BBC 1 29 August 2021 9pm	<i>The Avengers</i> Series 4, 'The Gravediggers', ITV 4 August 1966
Media Language	✓	✓
Media Representations	✓	✓
Media Industries	✓	✓
Media Audiences	✓	✓
Media Contexts	Social, Cultural	Social, Cultural, Historical

Centres are responsible for accessing these set products, which are available to stream or on DVD.

Vigil is a television drama illustrating, for example: the dominance of the police drama genre in contemporary television schedules and the industrial importance of the serial narrative form, the role of BBC1 in the contemporary television industry, how representations seek to reflect contemporary contexts, the offering of uses and gratifications to attract a mass audience in an increasingly segmented market.

The Avengers is a PG certificate drama illustrating a historically significant media product.

The Avengers was a landmark television series in the 1960s and reflects the brand image of ITV as more daring in this era. The media language is comparatively rich for a television product of this era and a monochrome episode has been set to illustrate changing television technology. *The Avengers* TV show helped define the 'spy drama' genre in the 1960s and was influenced by events occurring as it was filmed, including episodes that parodied current and historical events. *The Avengers* also included one of the first memorable examples of product placement (the 'Lotus Elan'), a technique which has great historical significance in contributing towards the funding of films and commercial television programmes in the present day.

The Avengers also illustrates the industrial importance of the series narrative form in 1960s television, the role of ITV in the era of three channel television, how representations reflect the 1960s contexts, how audience responses and interpretations may change over time as popular television products develop cult status.

The Avengers series is also a significant product due to its cultural and social impact and reach. *The Avengers* was a long-running series that was a mainstay of 1960s primetime television. Series four was sold to American television and the series played a role in representing 1960s Britain to the rest of the world – eventually showing in 120 countries – reinforcing stereotypes of the traditional British upper-class. It became a cult programme as an important example of 1960s popular drama and is still aired on British television today.

Learners must study at least the one set episode of each of these programmes in detail, practising

analysis of extracts, and developing their knowledge and understanding of the theoretical framework as it applies to the programmes as a whole.

Learners must study the contexts associated with the media products and develop an understanding of the differences between how the two media products illuminate the changing social, cultural, historical and political contexts of the mid-1960s and 2020s, enabling learners to develop a detailed understanding of how they appear in mainstream drama. It is recommended that learners investigate other similar media products from these periods to reinforce their understanding of how the two products reflect their contexts.

Learners must study the listed episodes in terms of all four areas of the theoretical framework, including the theoretical perspectives, and the media products' social, cultural, historical and political contexts, listed in the table at the end of Component 01.